

Answer Key

Grade 2 Passages

1. The Library Book

Setting: Maya's bedroom

Character: Maya

Beginning: Maya could not find her library book, and it was due.

1. She looked in her backpack, on her desk, and around the house.
2. She found the book under the bed.
3. She put it in her backpack.

Ending: Maya returned the book on time.

2. The Popped Ball

Setting: the gym

Character: Leo

Beginning: Leo popped the class ball.

1. Leo told Coach Ramirez the truth.
2. He taped the hole so the class could still use the ball.
3. Coach brought a new ball from the office.

Ending: Leo aimed away from the chairs, and his next shot stayed on the floor.

3. Ruby Gets Out

Setting: the classroom

Character: Nina

Beginning: Ruby the rabbit got out of the hutch.

1. Nina closed the classroom door.
2. She looked under the shelves and behind the paint jars.
3. She found Ruby in a box of paper scraps.

Ending: Nina put Ruby back and they added a second clip to the hutch.

4. The Forgotten Lunch

Setting: the cafeteria

Character: Jay

Beginning: Jay forgot his lunch.

1. Elena shared her sandwich and apple slices.
2. Jay helped Elena carry the ball bag at recess.
3. The next morning he packed an extra cheese stick for Elena.

Ending: Jay brought lunch and a thank-you snack for Elena.

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5. The Drooping Plant

Setting: the classroom

Character: Priya

Beginning: Priya's bean plant was drooping.

1. She and the teacher moved the pot to the sunny windowsill.
2. Priya gave the soil a small drink of water.
3. She wrote the date on a card and checked the soil each morning.

Ending: The stem lifted and the leaves felt firmer.

6. The Paper Crown

Setting: the school stage

Character: Omar

Beginning: The paper crown for the play was missing.

1. Omar checked the costume bin and the music stand.
2. Lila helped him cut and tape a new crown.
3. They drew three paper jewels on it.

Ending: Omar wore the new crown, remembered his lines, and saved it.

7. Mixed-Up Puzzle

Setting: the living room

Character: Ana

Beginning: Mateo bumped the table and mixed up Ana's puzzle.

1. Ana and Mateo picked up every piece.
2. They sorted edges and red pieces.
3. They rebuilt the border first.

Ending: They finished the puzzle, and Mateo put in the last piece.

8. Ants at the Picnic

Setting: the park

Character: Diego

Beginning: Ants crawled onto the picnic blanket.

1. Waving his hands did not stop the ants.
2. They packed the food into closed tubs and shook the blanket.
3. They carried everything to a picnic table.

Ending: They ate at the table, and the ants stayed in the grass.

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9. The Slipped Chain

Setting: the sidewalk by Rosa's street

Character: Rosa

Beginning: Rosa's bike chain slipped off.

1. She walked the bike to the sidewalk.
2. Mr. Brooks showed her how to set the chain with a stick.
3. Rosa tried again slowly, and the chain caught.

Ending: The chain stayed on, and Rosa rode home.

10. The Cloudy Tank

Setting: the classroom

Character: Ben

Beginning: The fish tank was cloudy from too much food.

1. Ben told Ms. Patel about the extra flakes.
2. He scooped the flakes out with a net.
3. They replaced some of the water.

Ending: The tank cleared, and Ben taped up a feeding chart.

11. Lost Glasses

Setting: school

Character: Elena

Beginning: Elena lost her glasses before a spelling test.

1. She checked her desk, the library bin, and the gym office.
2. She felt the case in her hoodie pocket.
3. She put the glasses on and went back to class.

Ending: Elena finished the test and clipped the case to her backpack.

12. Kite in the Tree

Setting: the park

Character: Malik

Beginning: Malik's kite was stuck in a tree.

1. Tugging the string did not free the kite.
2. Noor lifted the string with a long pole while Malik held the kite.
3. The loop slid free.

Ending: They flew the kite in the open field, away from the trees.

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13. A Cold Hamster

Setting: the classroom

Character: Lucy

Beginning: Pip the hamster was cold under the heating vent.

1. Lucy told Mr. Chen.
2. They moved the cage away from the vent.
3. Lucy added bedding and a cardboard hut.

Ending: Pip ran on his wheel, and they posted a sign about the vent.

14. The Smudged Painting

Setting: the art room

Character: Andre

Beginning: Andre's sleeve smudged the sun on his wet painting.

1. Ms. Brooks told him to wait until the paper dried.
2. Andre decided the smear could be a cloud.
3. He painted soft edges and two smaller clouds.

Ending: Andre hung the painting in the hall.

15. The Permission Slip

Setting: Sofia's kitchen

Character: Sofia

Beginning: Sofia's permission slip was missing on the day it was due.

1. She dumped her folder and found only old drawings.
2. She and her dad checked the backpack and the mail.
3. They found the blank slip in the kitchen drawer.

Ending: Dad signed the slip, and Sofia's name went on the trip list.

16. A Seat at the Game

Setting: the playground

Character: Camila

Beginning: Noah was new and sitting alone at recess.

1. Camila asked Noah to play kickball.
2. She explained kick, run, and tag the base.
3. She let him bat second so he could watch once.

Ending: Noah reached first base, and Camila saved him a spot the next day.

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17. Boxes Behind the Counter

Setting: the cookie sale table

Character: Hector

Beginning: Hector was two boxes short at the cookie sale.

1. He checked the supply closet and the teacher's desk.
2. He found two boxes behind the counter.
3. He counted again and the number matched his list.

Ending: Hector sold the cookies and moved the extra boxes where he could see them.

18. Vacuum Day

Setting: Amina's room

Character: Amina

Beginning: Bean hid and shook when Amina tried to vacuum.

1. Amina turned the vacuum off and let Bean sniff it.
2. She turned it on in the hall and tossed his ball.
3. Bean stayed in the doorway while she vacuumed a small square.

Ending: The next Saturday Bean watched from his bed and did not hide.

19. The Empty Feeder

Setting: Jonah's backyard

Character: Jonah

Beginning: The bird feeder was empty, so the birds flew off.

1. Jonah filled the feeder to the marked line.
2. He latched the lid.
3. He watched the chickadees come back.

Ending: Jonah wrote a reminder on the family calendar.

20. The Ripped Poster

Setting: the classroom

Character: Lila

Beginning: The water-cycle poster ripped before the presentation.

1. Lila showed her partners the rip instead of hiding it.
2. They taped the back of the poster.
3. Lila wrote the torn sentence again.

Ending: The poster stayed together during the presentation.